

DoView Tool G21 - How to Protect Morale in Community Programs Checklist

In an outcomes-focused world, experimenting with interventions seems like a sound idea. However, such an approach needs to be implemented carefully when working on community empowerment and mobilization in disempowered communities with low social morale.

Experimental approach

Pilot an initiative.

Determine whether the initiative achieves its outcomes.

Terminate initiatives that do not achieve their outcomes.

Start a new initiative, perhaps in a different community.

Community empowerment approach

Establish a long-term relationship and funding commitment with a community.

Assure the community that any piloting is the start of an ongoing process of addressing the community's issues.

Initiatives that fail to achieve their outcomes are not seen as 'failures' but provide learnings to better address issues in the long term.

Seamlessly morph any initiative that does not work into the next iteration of action.

Checklist

1. Is the community being worked with is one in which is disempowered? IF YES, THEN MORALE MAY BE AN ISSUE.
2. Does the community have a history of resources being withdrawn? IF YES, THEN MORALE MAY BE AN ISSUE.
3. Is it possible to have a long-term relationship with the community? IF NO, THEN MORALE MAY BE AN ISSUE.
4. Can the initiative be based in an ongoing institution in the community which will have a life beyond the initiative? IF NO, THEN MORALE MAY BE A ISSUE.
5. Can the lessons learnt from the initiative be transferred into a new initiative? IF NO, THEN MORALE MAY BE AN ISSUE.

Source: DOVIEW PLANNING AND PRACTICAL OUTCOMES THEORY HANDBOOK (2025). DoView Planning.Org. Copyright Dr Paul W Duignan.